The Menopause Diet for Busy Women

Easy Recipes, a 12-Week Meal Plan, and Simple Daily Practices to Support Weight Management, Energy, and Wellbeing

Neha Menon

The Printables

These pages accompany *The Menopause Diet for Busy Women* by Neha Menon. Print the weeks you need, stick them on the fridge, or save them on your phone. Recipe names and page references refer to the book.

CHAPTER 18

Weeks 1–12

Twelve weeks, eighty-four days, and not one evening spent wondering what's for dinner.

Each week has a focus, a 7-day menu, a snack plan, a shopping list and a Sunday prep plan, followed by a short check-in. The protein column shows the estimated total for each day, including the planned snacks; every day lands between about 80 and 110 grams, in line with the 2025–2030 Dietary Guidelines range of roughly 82 to 109 grams for a woman of around 150 pounds. Leftovers are planned in, so most dinners also become a lunch.

Quantities are in the recipes. Before you shop, check your pantry staples: olive oil, salt and pepper, spices, garlic, stock, canned tomatoes, oats and grains. And remember, this is a menu to borrow from, not a test: swap any meal for another with a similar protein figure, and skip whatever doesn't suit you.

Phase 1: Foundations

Week 1: Protein-First Breakfasts

This week is about one change: anchoring breakfast with protein. Two make-ahead breakfasts mean there's nothing to decide at 7 a.m., and a big pot of soup covers several lunches. Notice how your energy feels at 10:30 compared with last week.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈82 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Tuscan White Bean & Kale Soup **Dinner:** Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs
Tuesday **≈86 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Dinner:** Three-Bean Vegetable Chili **Snack:** Berry Greek Yogurt Bark
Wednesday **≈90 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Leftover Three-Bean Vegetable Chili **Dinner:** Baked Cod with Tomatoes, Olives & Capers **Snack:** Crispy Roasted Chickpeas, Three Ways
Thursday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Tuscan White Bean & Kale Soup **Dinner:** Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs
Friday **≈101 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Leftover Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Dinner:** Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Snack:** Berry Greek Yogurt Bark
Saturday **≈90 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Tuna & White Bean Niçoise Salad **Dinner:** Leftover Three-Bean Vegetable Chili **Snack:** Crispy Roasted Chickpeas, Three Ways
Sunday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Turmeric Tofu & Veggie Scramble **Lunch:** Tuscan White Bean & Kale Soup **Dinner:** Quinoa & Black Bean Stuffed Peppers **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs

Shopping list

Produce: avocados; baby spinach; bell peppers; berries (fresh or frozen); broccoli; carrots; celery; cherry tomatoes; cucumbers; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; green beans; kale; lemons; limes; mushrooms; new potatoes; onions; red onions; salad leaves; scallions; snow peas or snap peas; sweet potatoes.

Protein: cod fillets; eggs; lean ground turkey; salmon fillets; tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: cheddar or Monterey Jack cheese; cottage cheese; feta cheese; milk or unsweetened soy milk; Parmesan; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt).

Pantry: black beans, canned; brown rice; canned tomatoes; cannellini (white) beans, canned; capers; chia seeds; chickpeas, canned; dark chocolate (70% or higher); dijon mustard; ground flaxseed; low-sodium soy sauce or tamari; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; mixed beans, canned; olives; pumpkin seeds; quinoa; red wine vinegar; rice vinegar; rolled oats; tomato paste; walnuts; whole-grain or seeded rye bread; whole-grain pitas.

Freezer: corn (frozen or canned); frozen shelled edamame.

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Bake the Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins and make two jars of overnight oats.
2. Make the Tuscan White Bean & Kale Soup and portion it for three lunches.
3. Boil a batch of eggs and roast a tray of chickpeas for snacks.
4. Freeze the yogurt bark for the week.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

Week 2: Plants and Fiber

This week we add plants: aim for 30 different ones by Sunday, counting every vegetable, fruit, bean, grain, nut, seed, herb and spice. If you're not used to much fiber, drink plenty of water and let your gut adjust gradually.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈85 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Mediterranean Lentil & Roasted Vegetable Salad **Dinner:** Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Snack:** Hummus & Rainbow Crudités Box + Apple Slices with Almond Butter & Cinnamon
Tuesday **≈85 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Green Glow Protein Smoothie **Lunch:** Leftover Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Dinner:** Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Snack:** Apple Slices with Almond Butter & Cinnamon
Wednesday **≈83 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Mediterranean Lentil & Roasted Vegetable Salad **Dinner:** West African Peanut & Sweet Potato Stew **Snack:** Walnut-Date Energy Bites + Hummus & Rainbow Crudités Box
Thursday **≈95 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Green Glow Protein Smoothie **Lunch:** Leftover Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Dinner:** Shrimp & Vegetable Fajita Bowls **Snack:** Hummus & Rainbow Crudités Box
Friday **≈85 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover West African Peanut & Sweet Potato Stew **Dinner:** Quinoa & Black Bean Stuffed Peppers **Snack:** Apple Slices with Almond Butter & Cinnamon
Saturday **≈83 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Besan Chilla with Mint Yogurt **Lunch:** Quinoa Tabbouleh with Chickpeas **Dinner:** Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Snack:** Walnut-Date Energy Bites
Sunday **≈85 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Besan Chilla with Mint Yogurt **Lunch:** Quinoa Tabbouleh with Chickpeas **Dinner:** Slow-Cooker Moroccan Chicken with Apricots **Snack:** Hummus & Rainbow Crudités Box

Shopping list

Produce: apple; avocados; baby spinach; bell peppers; berries (fresh or frozen); broccoli; carrots; cauliflower; celery; cherry tomatoes; cucumbers; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; lemons; limes; mushrooms; onions; red onions; scallions; snow peas or snap peas; sweet potatoes; tomato; zucchini.

Protein: boneless, skinless chicken thighs; shrimp; tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: cheddar or Monterey Jack cheese; feta cheese; milk or unsweetened soy milk; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt).

Pantry: almond butter; almonds; black beans, canned; black-eyed peas; brown rice; canned tomatoes; chia seeds; chickpea flour; chickpeas, canned; dijon mustard; dried apricots; green chili; ground flaxseed; hemp seeds; hummus; lentils; low-sodium soy sauce or tamari; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; natural peanut butter; olives; pumpkin seeds; quinoa; red wine vinegar; rice vinegar; rolled oats; salsa; soft pitted dates; tomato paste; walnuts; whole-grain or seeded rye bread; whole-grain pasta.

Freezer: corn (frozen or canned); frozen banana; frozen mango or pineapple chunks; frozen shelled edamame.

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Roast the vegetables and make the Mediterranean Lentil Salad for three lunches.
2. Make two jars of overnight oats and portion smoothie packs into freezer bags.
3. Roll a batch of Walnut-Date Energy Bites.
4. Make the tabbouleh on Saturday morning for the weekend.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

Week 3: Hydration and Hot-Flash Comfort

This week focuses on cooling, hydrating meals and on noticing your personal triggers. Keep a pitcher of Cucumber-Mint Cooling Water in the fridge, keep spice on the side, and use your symptom diary to spot patterns. Remember, these are comfort measures; if hot flashes are disrupting your life, see Chapter 6.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈93 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Sesame Edamame Noodle Bowl **Dinner:** Baked Cod with Tomatoes, Olives & Capers **Snack:** Cottage Cheese & Cherry Tomato Bowl
Tuesday **≈91 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Green Glow Protein Smoothie **Lunch:** Quinoa Tabbouleh with Chickpeas **Dinner:** Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Snack:** Frozen Yogurt-Dipped Blueberries
Wednesday **≈95 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Leftover Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Dinner:** Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Snack:** Chili-Lime Edamame
Thursday **≈93 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Quinoa Tabbouleh with Chickpeas **Dinner:** Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Snack:** Cottage Cheese & Cherry Tomato Bowl
Friday **≈101 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Leftover Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Dinner:** Shrimp & Vegetable Fajita Bowls **Snack:** Frozen Yogurt-Dipped Blueberries
Saturday **≈90 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Green Glow Protein Smoothie **Lunch:** Tuna & White Bean Niçoise Salad **Dinner:** Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Snack:** Chili-Lime Edamame
Sunday **≈93 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Turmeric Tofu & Veggie Scramble **Lunch:** Leftover Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Dinner:** Chicken Pozole Verde **Snack:** Cottage Cheese & Cherry Tomato Bowl

Shopping list

Produce: avocados; baby spinach; bell peppers; berries (fresh or frozen); broccoli; carrots; cauliflower; cherry tomatoes; cucumbers; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; green beans; green cabbage; jalapeño; lemons; limes; mushrooms; new potatoes; onions; poblano peppers; red cabbage; red onions; salad leaves; scallions; snow peas or snap peas; sweet potatoes; tomatillos.

Protein: boneless, skinless chicken thighs; cod fillets; eggs; lean ground turkey; salmon fillets; shrimp; tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: cottage cheese; feta cheese; milk or unsweetened soy milk; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt).

Pantry: almonds; black beans, canned; brown rice; canned tomatoes; cannellini (white) beans, canned; capers; chickpeas, canned; dijon mustard; ground flaxseed; low-sodium soy sauce or tamari; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; olives; pumpkin seeds; quinoa; red wine vinegar; rice vinegar; rolled oats; salsa; sesame seeds; soba or whole-wheat noodles; tahini or natural peanut butter; walnuts; white hominy; whole-grain or seeded rye bread; whole-grain pitas.

Freezer: corn (frozen or canned); frozen banana; frozen mango or pineapple chunks; frozen shelled edamame.

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Bake the egg muffins and make the tabbouleh.
2. Make the sesame dressing and cook the soba for Monday's lunch.
3. Freeze a tray of yogurt-dipped blueberries.
4. Fill a pitcher of Cucumber-Mint Cooling Water.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

Week 4: Bones: Calcium and Vitamin D

This week every day includes at least two calcium-rich foods, from Greek yogurt and calcium-set tofu to cheese and fortified soy milk, and oily fish brings vitamin D. Pair it with your two strength sessions from Part Six: food and loading work together for your bones.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈97 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Leftover Chicken Pozole Verde **Dinner:** Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Snack:** Mini Caprese Skewers
Tuesday **≈103 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Miso-Glazed Tofu Buddha Bowl **Dinner:** Quinoa & Black Bean Stuffed Peppers **Snack:** Cottage Cheese & Cherry Tomato Bowl
Wednesday **≈102 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Leftover Quinoa & Black Bean Stuffed Peppers **Dinner:** Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Snack:** Vanilla Chia Pudding Cups
Thursday **≈102 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Leftover Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Dinner:** Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Snack:** Mini Caprese Skewers
Friday **≈98 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Leftover Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Dinner:** Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Snack:** Cottage Cheese & Cherry Tomato Bowl
Saturday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Smoked Salmon & Avocado Rye Toast **Lunch:** Smashed Chickpea Salad Sandwich **Dinner:** Baked Cod with Tomatoes, Olives & Capers **Snack:** Vanilla Chia Pudding Cups
Sunday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Turmeric Tofu & Veggie Scramble **Lunch:** Leftover Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Dinner:** Three-Bean Vegetable Chili **Snack:** Mini Caprese Skewers

Shopping list

Produce: avocados; baby spinach; bell peppers; berries (fresh or frozen); broccoli; carrots; cauliflower; celery; cherry tomatoes; cucumbers; fresh fruit and a few chopped nuts; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; green cabbage; jalapeño; lemons; limes; mushrooms; onions; poblano peppers; red onions; salad leaves; scallions; snow peas or snap peas; sweet potatoes; tomatillos; tomato.

Protein: boneless, skinless chicken thighs; cod fillets; eggs; lean ground turkey; salmon fillets; smoked salmon; tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: cheddar or Monterey Jack cheese; cottage cheese; feta cheese; milk or unsweetened soy milk; mozzarella pearls; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt).

Pantry: black beans, canned; brown rice; canned tomatoes; cannellini (white) beans, canned; capers; capers or chopped pickles; chia seeds; chickpeas, canned; dijon mustard; ground flaxseed; low-sodium soy sauce or tamari; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; mixed beans, canned; olives; pumpkin seeds; quinoa; rice vinegar; rolled oats; sesame seeds; tahini; tahini or vegan mayonnaise; tomato paste; walnuts; white hominy; white miso paste; whole-grain or seeded rye bread; whole-grain pitas.

Freezer: corn (frozen or canned); frozen shelled edamame.

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Bake the egg muffins and press and cube two blocks of calcium-set tofu.
2. Make two jars of chia pudding with soy milk.
3. Stuff the peppers ahead for Tuesday.
4. Check your vitamin D: is a supplement right for you? Ask at your next appointment.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

Phase 2: Build

Week 5: Balancing Blood Sugar

This week is about steady energy: never more than four or five hours without eating, protein and fiber at every meal, and a planned snack for the time of day your cravings usually strike. Try a 10-minute walk after dinner on at least three evenings.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈92 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Three-Bean Vegetable Chili **Dinner:** Slow-Cooker Moroccan Chicken with Apricots **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs
Tuesday **≈90 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Leftover Slow-Cooker Moroccan Chicken with Apricots **Dinner:** Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Snack:** Apple Slices with Almond Butter & Cinnamon
Wednesday **≈103 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Lemon Herb Chicken Grain Bowl **Dinner:** Shrimp & Vegetable Fajita Bowls **Snack:** Spiced Pumpkin Seed Trail Mix
Thursday **≈97 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Lemon Herb Chicken Grain Bowl **Dinner:** Leftover Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs
Friday **≈95 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Lemon Herb Chicken Grain Bowl **Dinner:** West African Peanut & Sweet Potato Stew **Snack:** Apple Slices with Almond Butter & Cinnamon
Saturday **≈83 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Besan Chilla with Mint Yogurt **Lunch:** Leftover West African Peanut & Sweet Potato Stew **Dinner:** Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Snack:** Spiced Pumpkin Seed Trail Mix
Sunday **≈92 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Turmeric Tofu & Veggie Scramble **Lunch:** Mediterranean Lentil & Roasted Vegetable Salad **Dinner:** Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs

Shopping list

Produce: apple; avocados; baby spinach; bell peppers; berries (fresh or frozen); broccoli; carrots; celery; cherry tomatoes; cucumbers; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; lemons; limes; mushrooms; onions; red onions; scallions; sweet potatoes; tomato; zucchini.

Protein: boneless, skinless chicken thighs; chicken breasts or thighs; eggs; lean ground turkey; salmon fillets; shrimp; tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: cottage cheese; feta cheese; milk or unsweetened soy milk; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt).

Pantry: almond butter; almonds; black beans, canned; black-eyed peas; brown rice; canned tomatoes; chia seeds; chickpea flour; chickpeas, canned; dijon mustard; dried apricots; farro; green chili; ground flaxseed; hemp seeds; hummus; lentils; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; mixed beans, canned; natural peanut butter; olives; pumpkin seeds; quinoa; red wine vinegar; rolled oats; salsa; tomato paste; unsweetened dried cherries or raisins; walnuts; whole-grain or seeded rye bread; whole-grain pasta; whole-grain pitas.

Freezer: corn (frozen or canned).

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Make the Lemon Herb Chicken Grain Bowls for three lunches.
2. Bake the egg muffins and make two jars of overnight oats.
3. Set up the slow cooker for Monday's Moroccan chicken.
4. Roast a batch of trail mix and boil eggs.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

Week 6: Omega-3s and Mood

This week brings oily fish to the table at least twice, plus walnuts, flaxseed and chia every day. Take a moment each evening for the gratitude note from Chapter 5, and notice whether your mood feels any steadier by the weekend.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈97 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Dinner:** Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Snack:** Smoked Salmon Cucumber Bites
Tuesday **≈88 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Leftover Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Dinner:** Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Snack:** Walnut-Date Energy Bites
Wednesday **≈88 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Dinner:** Baked Cod with Tomatoes, Olives & Capers **Snack:** Spiced Pumpkin Seed Trail Mix
Thursday **≈92 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Tuna & White Bean Niçoise Salad **Dinner:** Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Snack:** Smoked Salmon Cucumber Bites
Friday **≈88 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Dinner:** Shrimp & Vegetable Fajita Bowls **Snack:** Walnut-Date Energy Bites
Saturday **≈90 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Smoked Salmon & Avocado Rye Toast **Lunch:** Sesame Edamame Noodle Bowl **Dinner:** West African Peanut & Sweet Potato Stew **Snack:** Spiced Pumpkin Seed Trail Mix + Smoked Salmon Cucumber Bites
Sunday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Smoked Salmon & Avocado Rye Toast **Lunch:** Leftover West African Peanut & Sweet Potato Stew **Dinner:** Chicken Pozole Verde **Snack:** Smoked Salmon Cucumber Bites

Shopping list

Produce: avocados; baby spinach; bell peppers; berries (fresh or frozen); broccoli; carrots; cauliflower; celery; cherry tomatoes; cucumbers; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; green beans; green cabbage; jalapeño; lemons; limes; mushrooms; new potatoes; onions; poblano peppers; red cabbage; red onions; salad leaves; scallions; sweet potatoes; tomatillos.

Protein: boneless, skinless chicken thighs; cod fillets; eggs; lean ground turkey; salmon fillets; shrimp; smoked salmon; tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: feta cheese; milk or unsweetened soy milk; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt).

Pantry: almonds; black beans, canned; black-eyed peas; brown rice; canned tomatoes; cannellini (white) beans, canned; capers; chia seeds; chickpeas, canned; dijon mustard; ground flaxseed; hemp seeds; lentils; low-sodium soy sauce or tamari; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; natural peanut butter; olives; pumpkin seeds; red wine vinegar; rice vinegar; rolled oats; salsa; sesame seeds; soba or whole-wheat noodles; soft pitted dates; tahini or natural peanut butter; tomato paste; unsweetened dried cherries or raisins; walnuts; white hominy; whole-grain or seeded rye bread; whole-grain pasta; whole-grain pitas.

Freezer: frozen shelled edamame.

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Make two jars of overnight oats with extra ground flaxseed.
2. Roll the energy bites and roast the trail mix.
3. Make the Bolognese sauce and freeze half for a later week.
4. Hard-boil eggs for Thursday's Niçoise.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

Week 7: Sleep-Supporting Evenings

This week's dinners are a little lighter and earlier, with a calming bedtime snack if you need one. Set a 2 p.m. caffeine curfew, swap one evening drink for a Tart Cherry Evening Spritz, and try one of the evening practices from Part Six.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈97 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Leftover Chicken Pozole Verde **Dinner:** Baked Cod with Tomatoes, Olives & Capers **Snack:** Baked Cinnamon Pear with Walnuts
Tuesday **≈92 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Green Glow Protein Smoothie **Lunch:** Tuscan White Bean & Kale Soup **Dinner:** Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Snack:** Vanilla Chia Pudding Cups
Wednesday **≈98 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Leftover Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Dinner:** Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Snack:** Golden Turmeric Latte
Thursday **≈82 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Green Glow Protein Smoothie **Lunch:** Tuscan White Bean & Kale Soup **Dinner:** Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Snack:** Baked Cinnamon Pear with Walnuts
Friday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Leftover Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Dinner:** Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Snack:** Vanilla Chia Pudding Cups
Saturday **≈83 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Ginger Brown Rice Congee with Soft Egg **Lunch:** Tuscan White Bean & Kale Soup **Dinner:** Quinoa & Black Bean Stuffed Peppers **Snack:** Golden Turmeric Latte
Sunday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Ginger Brown Rice Congee with Soft Egg **Lunch:** Leftover Quinoa & Black Bean Stuffed Peppers **Dinner:** Spiced Red Lentil Dal with Spinach **Snack:** Baked Cinnamon Pear with Walnuts

Shopping list

Produce: baby spinach; bell peppers; broccoli; carrots; cauliflower; celery; cherry tomatoes; cucumbers; fresh fruit and a few chopped nuts; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; green cabbage; jalapeño; kale; lemons; limes; mushrooms; onions; poblano peppers; ripe pears; scallions; snow peas or snap peas; sweet potatoes; tomatillos.

Protein: boneless, skinless chicken thighs; cod fillets; eggs; lean ground turkey; salmon fillets; tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: cheddar or Monterey Jack cheese; cottage cheese; feta cheese; milk or unsweetened soy milk; Parmesan; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt).

Pantry: almonds; black beans, canned; brown rice; canned tomatoes; cannellini (white) beans, canned; capers; chia seeds; chickpeas, canned; chili crisp or sliced fresh chili; dijon mustard; ground flaxseed; lentils; low-sodium soy sauce or tamari; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; mustard seeds; olives; quinoa; rice vinegar; rolled oats; sesame seeds; walnuts; white hominy; whole-grain pitas.

Freezer: corn (frozen or canned); frozen banana; frozen mango or pineapple chunks; frozen shelled edamame.

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Make the Tuscan soup for three lunches.
2. Bake the egg muffins and portion smoothie packs.
3. Make chia pudding for two evenings.
4. Start the congee on Saturday morning; it keeps for Sunday too.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

Week 8: Happy Gut, Less Bloating

This week includes a fermented food every day (yogurt, kefir, miso) and keeps fiber steady rather than sudden. Eat slowly, take a short walk after meals, and notice which foods leave you comfortable and which don't.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈89 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Ginger Brown Rice Congee with Soft Egg **Lunch:** Leftover Spiced Red Lentil Dal with Spinach **Dinner:** Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Snack:** Kefir Berry Shake
Tuesday **≈110 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Miso-Glazed Tofu Buddha Bowl **Dinner:** Slow-Cooker Moroccan Chicken with Apricots **Snack:** Chili-Lime Edamame
Wednesday **≈105 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Ginger Brown Rice Congee with Soft Egg **Lunch:** Leftover Slow-Cooker Moroccan Chicken with Apricots **Dinner:** Baked Cod with Tomatoes, Olives & Capers **Snack:** Chili-Lime Edamame
Thursday **≈109 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Leftover Slow-Cooker Moroccan Chicken with Apricots **Dinner:** Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Snack:** Kefir Berry Shake
Friday **≈92 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Dinner:** Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Snack:** Vanilla Chia Pudding Cups
Saturday **≈105 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Miso-Glazed Tofu Buddha Bowl **Dinner:** Shrimp & Vegetable Fajita Bowls **Snack:** Chili-Lime Edamame
Sunday **≈89 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Turmeric Tofu & Veggie Scramble **Lunch:** Leftover Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Dinner:** Three-Bean Vegetable Chili **Snack:** Kefir Berry Shake

Shopping list

Produce: avocados; baby spinach; bell peppers; berries (fresh or frozen); broccoli; carrots; celery; cherry tomatoes; fresh fruit and a few chopped nuts; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; lemons; limes; mushrooms; onions; red onions; scallions; snow peas or snap peas; sweet potatoes.

Protein: boneless, skinless chicken thighs; cod fillets; eggs; salmon fillets; shrimp; tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: milk or unsweetened soy milk; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt); plain kefir.

Pantry: black beans, canned; brown rice; canned tomatoes; cannellini (white) beans, canned; capers; chia seeds; chickpeas, canned; chili crisp or sliced fresh chili; dijon mustard; dried apricots; ground flaxseed; lentils; low-sodium soy sauce or tamari; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; mixed beans, canned; mustard seeds; olives; pumpkin seeds; quinoa; red wine vinegar; rice vinegar; rolled oats; salsa; sesame seeds; tahini; tomato paste; walnuts; white miso paste; whole-grain or seeded rye bread; whole-grain pasta.

Freezer: corn (frozen or canned); frozen shelled edamame.

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Make a pot of congee for three breakfasts.
2. Marinate and bake the miso tofu for two lunches.
3. Set up the slow cooker for Tuesday's Moroccan chicken.
4. Make chia pudding and keep kefir in the fridge for shakes.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

Phase 3: Thrive

Week 9: Plant Power and Phytoestrogens

This week leans on soy and other plant proteins: tofu, edamame, soy milk, chickpeas and lentils, plus a daily spoonful of ground flaxseed. Enjoy them for their protein, fiber and calcium; any effect on hot flashes is a bonus.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈90 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Three-Bean Vegetable Chili **Dinner:** Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Snack:** Chili-Lime Edamame
Tuesday **≈97 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Green Glow Protein Smoothie **Lunch:** Leftover Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Dinner:** Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Snack:** Vanilla Chia Pudding Cups
Wednesday **≈80 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Sesame Edamame Noodle Bowl **Dinner:** West African Peanut & Sweet Potato Stew **Snack:** Hummus & Rainbow Crudités Box
Thursday **≈90 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Green Glow Protein Smoothie **Lunch:** Leftover West African Peanut & Sweet Potato Stew **Dinner:** Quinoa & Black Bean Stuffed Peppers **Snack:** Chili-Lime Edamame
Friday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Smashed Chickpea Salad Sandwich **Dinner:** Leftover Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Snack:** Vanilla Chia Pudding Cups + Hummus & Rainbow Crudités Box
Saturday **≈100 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Turmeric Tofu & Veggie Scramble **Lunch:** Miso-Glazed Tofu Buddha Bowl **Dinner:** Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Snack:** Hummus & Rainbow Crudités Box
Sunday **≈80 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Besan Chilla with Mint Yogurt **Lunch:** Leftover Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Dinner:** Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Snack:** Chili-Lime Edamame

Shopping list

Produce: avocados; baby spinach; bell peppers; berries (fresh or frozen); broccoli; carrots; cauliflower; celery; cucumbers; fresh fruit and a few chopped nuts; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; lemons; limes; mushrooms; onions; red cabbage; red onions; salad leaves; scallions; snow peas or snap peas; sweet potatoes; tomato.

Protein: tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: cheddar or Monterey Jack cheese; milk or unsweetened soy milk; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt).

Pantry: almonds; black beans, canned; black-eyed peas; brown rice; canned tomatoes; capers or chopped pickles; chia seeds; chickpea flour; chickpeas, canned; dijon mustard; green chili; ground flaxseed; hummus; lentils; low-sodium soy sauce or tamari; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; mixed beans, canned; natural peanut butter; quinoa; red wine vinegar; rice vinegar; rolled oats; sesame seeds; soba or whole-wheat noodles; tahini; tahini or natural peanut butter; tahini or vegan mayonnaise; tomato paste; walnuts; white miso paste; whole-grain or seeded rye bread; whole-grain pasta.

Freezer: corn (frozen or canned); frozen banana; frozen mango or pineapple chunks; frozen shelled edamame.

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Make two jars of overnight oats with soy milk.
2. Press two blocks of tofu for the stir-fry and miso bowl.
3. Make the sesame dressing for Wednesday's noodles.
4. Portion smoothie packs and make chia pudding.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

Week 10: Batch-Cook Week

This week does the heavy lifting on Sunday so the weekdays almost cook themselves. Three big batches (pozole, chili and dal) plus make-ahead breakfasts cover most of the week. Freeze any extra portions for the weeks ahead.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈82 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Spiced Red Lentil Dal with Spinach **Dinner:** Chicken Pozole Verde **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs
Tuesday **≈85 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Chicken Pozole Verde **Dinner:** Three-Bean Vegetable Chili **Snack:** Crispy Roasted Chickpeas, Three Ways
Wednesday **≈81 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Spiced Red Lentil Dal with Spinach **Dinner:** Leftover Chicken Pozole Verde **Snack:** Berry Greek Yogurt Bark
Thursday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Three-Bean Vegetable Chili **Dinner:** Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs
Friday **≈86 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Spiced Red Lentil Dal with Spinach **Dinner:** Leftover Three-Bean Vegetable Chili **Snack:** Crispy Roasted Chickpeas, Three Ways + Berry Greek Yogurt Bark
Saturday **≈101 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Leftover Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Dinner:** Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Snack:** Berry Greek Yogurt Bark
Sunday **≈107 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Turmeric Tofu & Veggie Scramble **Lunch:** Leftover Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Dinner:** Slow-Cooker Moroccan Chicken with Apricots **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs

Shopping list

Produce: avocados; baby spinach; berries (fresh or frozen); broccoli; carrots; cherry tomatoes; cucumbers; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; green cabbage; jalapeño; lemons; limes; mushrooms; onions; poblano peppers; red onions; scallions; sweet potatoes; tomatillos.

Protein: boneless, skinless chicken thighs; eggs; lean ground turkey; salmon fillets; tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: cottage cheese; feta cheese; milk or unsweetened soy milk; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt).

Pantry: brown rice; canned tomatoes; chia seeds; chickpeas, canned; dark chocolate (70% or higher); dijon mustard; dried apricots; ground flaxseed; lentils; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; mixed beans, canned; mustard seeds; pumpkin seeds; quinoa; rolled oats; tomato paste; walnuts; white hominy; whole-grain or seeded rye bread; whole-grain pitas.

Freezer: corn (frozen or canned).

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Make the Chicken Pozole Verde and the Three-Bean Vegetable Chili.
2. Make the Spiced Red Lentil Dal for three lunches.
3. Bake the egg muffins and make two jars of overnight oats.
4. Boil eggs, roast chickpeas and freeze the yogurt bark.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

Week 11: Real Life: Eating Out and Social Occasions

This week includes three meals out, because real life does. When you eat out, look for a palm-and-a-half of protein and plenty of plants, enjoy what you choose, and pick up your usual routine at the next meal. One meal never undoes a week.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈97 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Slow-Cooker Moroccan Chicken with Apricots **Dinner:** Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Snack:** Tamari-Roasted Almonds
Tuesday **≈102 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Leftover Ginger-Garlic Tofu & Vegetable Stir-Fry **Dinner:** Baked Cod with Tomatoes, Olives & Capers **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs
Wednesday **≈90 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Slow-Cooker Moroccan Chicken with Apricots **Dinner:** *Meal out (see tips)* **Snack:** Apple Slices with Almond Butter & Cinnamon
Thursday **≈92 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Spinach & Feta Egg Muffins **Lunch:** Tuna & White Bean Niçoise Salad **Dinner:** Shrimp & Vegetable Fajita Bowls **Snack:** Tamari-Roasted Almonds
Friday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Black Bean, Corn & Avocado Tacos **Dinner:** *Meal out (see tips)* **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs + Apple Slices with Almond Butter & Cinnamon
Saturday **≈80 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Smoked Salmon & Avocado Rye Toast **Lunch:** *Meal out (see tips)* **Dinner:** West African Peanut & Sweet Potato Stew **Snack:** Apple Slices with Almond Butter & Cinnamon
Sunday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Turmeric Tofu & Veggie Scramble **Lunch:** Leftover West African Peanut & Sweet Potato Stew **Dinner:** Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Snack:** Tamari-Roasted Almonds

Eating out: choose a dish built around fish, chicken, beans, eggs or tofu, add vegetables or a salad, and enjoy it. A meal out is counted at about 25 grams of protein.

Shopping list

Produce: apple; avocados; baby spinach; bell peppers; berries (fresh or frozen); broccoli; carrots; cherry tomatoes; cucumbers; finely shredded red and green cabbage; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; green beans; lemons; limes; mushrooms; new potatoes; onions; red onions; salad leaves; scallions; snow peas or snap peas; sweet potatoes.

Protein: boneless, skinless chicken thighs; cod fillets; eggs; salmon fillets; shrimp; smoked salmon; tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: cottage cheese; feta cheese; milk or unsweetened soy milk; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt).

Pantry: almond butter; almonds; black beans, canned; black-eyed peas; brown rice; canned tomatoes; cannellini (white) beans, canned; capers; chia seeds; chickpeas, canned; dijon mustard; dried apricots; ground flaxseed; hemp seeds; low-sodium soy sauce or tamari; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; natural peanut butter; olives; quinoa; red wine vinegar; rice vinegar; rolled oats; salsa; salsa or pico de gallo; tomato paste; tortillas; walnuts; whole-grain or seeded rye bread.

Freezer: corn (frozen or canned); frozen shelled edamame.

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Make two jars of overnight oats and bake the egg muffins.
2. Roast the almonds and boil eggs: they travel well.
3. Look up the menus for your meals out and decide in advance if that helps you.
4. Keep Saturday's peanut stew simple: it makes Sunday's lunch too.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

Week 12: Your Personal Plan

This final week is built from the recipes that readers most often keep on repeat. Use it as a model for your own plan: keep the breakfasts you loved, the batch-cook habits that saved you time, and the snacks that steadied your afternoons. Appendix B has a blank weekly planner.

Day	Meals
Monday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Mediterranean Lentil & Roasted Vegetable Salad **Dinner:** Quinoa & Black Bean Stuffed Peppers **Snack:** Seeded Rye Crispbread with Ricotta & Pear
Tuesday **≈88 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Besan Chilla with Mint Yogurt **Lunch:** Leftover Quinoa & Black Bean Stuffed Peppers **Dinner:** Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Snack:** Cottage Cheese & Cherry Tomato Bowl
Wednesday **≈92 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Greek Yogurt Power Bowl with Walnuts & Seeds **Lunch:** Leftover Coconut Chickpea & Vegetable Curry **Dinner:** Sheet-Pan Salmon with Broccoli & Sweet Potato **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs
Thursday **≈90 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Mediterranean Lentil & Roasted Vegetable Salad **Dinner:** Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Snack:** Seeded Rye Crispbread with Ricotta & Pear + Cottage Cheese & Cherry Tomato Bowl
Friday **≈93 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Golden Flax & Berry Overnight Oats **Lunch:** Leftover Lentil Bolognese with Whole-Grain Pasta **Dinner:** Shrimp & Vegetable Fajita Bowls **Snack:** Cottage Cheese & Cherry Tomato Bowl
Saturday **≈87 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Ginger Brown Rice Congee with Soft Egg **Lunch:** Black Bean, Corn & Avocado Tacos **Dinner:** Chicken Pozole Verde **Snack:** Everything-Seasoned Boiled Eggs
Sunday **≈102 g protein**	**Breakfast:** Turmeric Tofu & Veggie Scramble **Lunch:** Leftover Chicken Pozole Verde **Dinner:** Greek Turkey Meatballs with Tzatziki **Snack:** Seeded Rye Crispbread with Ricotta & Pear

Shopping list

Produce: avocados; baby spinach; bell peppers; berries (fresh or frozen); broccoli; carrots; cauliflower; celery; cherry tomatoes; cucumbers; finely shredded red and green cabbage; fresh herbs (dill, parsley, cilantro, mint or basil); garlic; green cabbage; jalapeño; lemons; limes; mushrooms; onions; pear; poblano peppers; red onions; scallions; sweet potatoes; tomatillos; tomato; zucchini.

Protein: boneless, skinless chicken thighs; eggs; lean ground turkey; salmon fillets; shrimp; tofu (firm and extra-firm, calcium-set if possible).

Dairy and alternatives: cheddar or Monterey Jack cheese; cottage cheese; feta cheese; milk or unsweetened soy milk; part-skim ricotta; plain Greek yogurt (or soy yogurt).

Pantry: black beans, canned; brown rice; canned tomatoes; chia seeds; chickpea flour; chickpeas, canned; chili crisp or sliced fresh chili; dijon mustard; green chili; ground flaxseed; lentils; low-sodium soy sauce or tamari; low-sodium stock; maple syrup or honey; olives; pumpkin seeds; quinoa; red wine vinegar; rolled oats; salsa; salsa or pico de gallo; sesame seeds; tomato paste; tortillas; walnuts; white hominy; whole-grain or seeded rye bread; whole-grain pasta; whole-grain pitas.

Freezer: corn (frozen or canned).

Sunday prep (60 to 90 minutes)

1. Make the lentil salad for two lunches and stuff the peppers for Monday.
2. Make two jars of overnight oats.
3. Boil eggs and buy ricotta and crispbread for snacks.
4. Sit down with Appendix B and sketch next week's plan.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN

- ☐ How was my energy this week, from 1 to 10?
- ☐ How did I sleep, and did anything help?
- ☐ Which symptoms changed, for better or worse?
- ☐ Which meals do I want to keep, and which can go?
- ☐ One win I'm proud of this week:

CHAPTER SUMMARY

- Twelve themed weeks in three phases: Foundations, Build and Thrive.
- Every day reaches roughly 80 to 110 grams of protein from three meals and planned snacks.
- Leftovers are built in, so most dinners become a lunch, and a Sunday prep hour keeps the week easy.
- The plan is a guide: swap meals freely, keep what works, and use Appendix B to build your own.

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Food is half of the plan. The other half happens on the floor of your living room, in thirty days of yoga, strength and calm.

Appendices

These tools are designed to be used: print as many copies as you like.

Appendix A: Symptom & Mood Tracker

Fill in one column each evening. For the 1 to 5 scores, 1 means "very poor" or "very bothersome" and 5 means "very good" or "not at all." Bring a few weeks of entries to your next appointment.

Week of:	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Hot flashes (number)							
Night sweats (yes/no)							
Sleep quality (1–5)							
Energy (1–5)							
Mood (1–5)							
Anxiety (1–5)							
Brain fog (1–5)							
Joint aches (1–5)							
Bloating (1–5)							
Bleeding or spotting							
Strength or yoga done							
Alcohol and caffeine							
Notes							

Appendix B: Weekly Meal Planner

Use this with the 20-minute planning routine in Chapter 12. Aim to include protein at every meal and plants on every plate.

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snack
Monday				
Tuesday				
Wednesday				
Thursday				
Friday				
Saturday				
Sunday				

Batch-cook this week: _____

Sunday prep plan: _____

Shopping list: _____

_____

_____

Appendix C: Master Grocery List

Tick what you need before you shop. The full list, with suggestions, is in Chapter 12.

Produce: ☐ leafy greens ☐ broccoli or cauliflower ☐ bell peppers ☐ carrots ☐ tomatoes ☐ onions and garlic ☐ fresh ginger ☐ sweet potatoes ☐ berries ☐ apples or pears ☐ lemons and limes ☐ avocados ☐ fresh herbs

Protein: ☐ eggs ☐ salmon or other fish ☐ chicken or turkey ☐ tofu (calcium-set) ☐ canned tuna, salmon or sardines

Dairy and alternatives: ☐ plain Greek yogurt ☐ kefir ☐ cottage cheese ☐ milk or fortified soy milk ☐ feta or other cheese

Pantry: ☐ rolled oats ☐ quinoa or brown rice ☐ whole-grain pasta ☐ whole-grain or rye bread ☐ canned beans and chickpeas ☐ dried lentils ☐ canned tomatoes ☐ low-sodium stock ☐ nuts ☐ seeds and ground flaxseed ☐ nut butter ☐ olive oil ☐ tamari or soy sauce ☐ spices ☐ dark chocolate

Freezer: ☐ frozen vegetables ☐ frozen berries ☐ frozen edamame ☐ frozen fish or shrimp ☐ batch-cooked meals

Appendix D: Measurement & Conversion Charts

Volume (US)	Metric (approx.)
1 teaspoon (tsp)	5 ml
1 tablespoon (tbsp)	15 ml
1/4 cup	60 ml
1/3 cup	80 ml
1/2 cup	120 ml
1 cup	240 ml
4 cups (1 quart)	950 ml

Weight (US)	Metric (approx.)
1 ounce (oz)	28 g

Weight (US)	Metric (approx.)
4 oz (1/4 lb)	115 g
8 oz (1/2 lb)	225 g
16 oz (1 lb)	450 g
2.2 lb	1 kg

Oven temperature	Celsius (conventional)	Celsius (fan/convection)
325°F	160°C	145°C
350°F	180°C	160°C
375°F	190°C	170°C
400°F	200°C	180°C
425°F	220°C	200°C

Food	Safe minimum internal temperature
Fish and shellfish	145°F (63°C)
Chicken and turkey, including ground	165°F (74°C)
Leftovers and reheated dishes	165°F (74°C)

Appendix E: Questions to Ask Your Healthcare Provider

Before your appointment

- ☐ Bring 4 to 8 weeks of your Symptom & Mood Tracker (Appendix A).
- ☐ List your medicines and supplements, with doses.
- ☐ Write down your top two concerns, so they come first.
- ☐ Note the date of your last period and any changes to your cycle.
- ☐ Consider bringing a partner or friend to help you remember what was said.

Questions to ask

- ☐ Are my symptoms likely to be caused by perimenopause or menopause?
- ☐ Do I need any tests, and why?
- ☐ Is hormone therapy a suitable option for me? What are the benefits and risks in my situation?
- ☐ Which type and form would you recommend, and why?
- ☐ What non-hormonal options could help, and what monitoring would they need?
- ☐ Could vaginal estrogen help with dryness, discomfort or bladder symptoms?
- ☐ Could my current medicines or supplements affect my symptoms or interact with treatment?
- ☐ Do I need a bone density scan, or cholesterol, blood sugar, thyroid, iron, vitamin D or B12 tests?
- ☐ Do I still need contraception, and until when?
- ☐ Can you refer me for CBT, pelvic floor therapy, a dietitian or a menopause specialist?
- ☐ When should we review how things are going?

Notes from my appointment

_____

_____

Appendix F: Trusted Resources & Organizations

These organizations offer reliable, evidence-based information. Website addresses change, so search for the organization's name if a link doesn't work.

- **The Menopause Society** (menopause.org): information for women and a directory of certified menopause practitioners.
- **Office on Women's Health, US Department of Health and Human Services** (womenshealth.gov): plain-language information on menopause and women's health.
- **National Institute on Aging** (nia.nih.gov): information on menopause, healthy aging, exercise and memory.
- **NIH Office of Dietary Supplements** (ods.od.nih.gov): fact sheets on vitamins, minerals and supplements.
- **Dietary Guidelines for Americans** (dietaryguidelines.gov) and **MyPlate** (myplate.gov).
- **Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics** (eatright.org): find a registered dietitian near you.
- **Bone Health & Osteoporosis Foundation** (bonehealthandosteoporosis.org): bone health, exercise and fracture prevention.
- **American Heart Association** (heart.org): heart health for women.
- **988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline**: call or text 988 in the United States, any time.
- **FORCE** (facingourrisk.org): support for people with inherited cancer risk, including BRCA mutations.
- **The Daisy Network** (daisynetwork.org): support for women with premature (primary) ovarian insufficiency.
- **NHS** (nhs.uk) and **NICE** (nice.org.uk): UK menopause information and guidance.